

Narrative

READ	Script - story
READ	Color Design // Lookbook // Reel // Director Materials
FIND	Images - Photography, Art, Visual References, Lookbook (initial ideas + feelings)
MEET	Shotlist with Director - scene by scene, find the style, rhythm, pacing, psychology, etc.
READ	Script - ideas, what would be cool, beat sheet , character breakdowns, motivation
READ	Script - emotion, subtext, themes, arcs , story again
READ	Script / Storyboard / Shotlist
READ	Script - technical - gear , art, lighting, and special equipment
READ	Script - Scene by Scene, shot by shot
READ	Script - Visual, Composition, Light, Color, Mood
READ	Script - Style - Master Shots
WATCH	Films + Commercial + Movie References + Photo Books
TEST	Camera / Lenses / Filters / Gear / Aesthetic of the Film / Hair Makeup Costumes
SELECT CREW	
SELECT GEAR	(Use David Claesson Template) . Compare to Grip Truck
FILTERS	(Diffusion, ND, Special Effects (Blink + Glare et al)
FIND	Images - Photography, Art, Visual References, Lookbook, Moodboard
WRITE	Mood Board + Treatment (for each department + speak to them or their ideas and notes)
WRITE	STYLE Bible (scene by scene, notes, images, camera floor plans, lighting diagrams, etc)
REVIEW	Script / Locations / Art / Wardrobe / Et al - how to achieve everything
READ	How to Direct Actors / ASC Manual / Set Lighting Technician's Book / Deakins Blog
READ	ASC Magazines / Visual Story / New Cinematographers / Cinematography Books
LISTEN	ASC Podcasts
PREP	Weeks before production Creative Prep as detailed above / DP Director meetings DP PD Director meetings - colors, wallpaper, practicals, paint, aesthetic, specifics 2 Weeks to production Location Scouting / Casting Sessions / Department Show and Tells / Re-writes DP Meeting - gaffer, key grip, 1st AC, DIT lock things down, answer questions Schedule - DP & AD 1 Week to production Tech Scout / Production Meeting / Schedule / Final Budgets / Equipment Pickups Camera Tests / Hair Make Up Tests / Post House Visit + Workflow / Test Viewings

DP Commercial Process

Get the Job

Talk with Director

Creative Call / Agency / Director Script + Boards

Location Scout / Give Feedback

Tech Scout

Plan

Visual Lookbook / Moodboard / Treatment

Location Lighting / Possible Locations (for each location)

Mood Lighting / Lighting Ideas

Camera Angles / Framing / Lenses / Composition

Movement

Inspiration Folder

LOOKBOOK

Reference Stills (numbered, four or so a page) (per scene or overall)

Lighting Examples - Thoughts, What I Need to Know, Notes

Camera Examples -

Shoot

Grade

Done

Commercial Directing

CREATIVE

Agency

Storyboards

My Concept

Script

Marked Script

Shotlist

PRACTICAL

Script

Creative Call listen, listen, listen

Treatment / Mood Board / Visual Lookbook
References

Casting w/ agency and options

Location Scout

Shoot

Creative	Think About - SEEING
Script	Tone (how does the film feel)
Marked Script	Aspect
	Composition
Shotlist	Symmetry or NO
	Color Palette / Swatch
Magic Binder	Contrast
Scene Breakdown	Camera Movement - pan, tilt, dolly, gyro, drone, handheld, sticks
Scene	Negative Space
Description	Pacing - Introduce, Hold On Shots. Frenetic.
Time of Day	Lighting - Natural
<i>Important Things about the scene + Feeling</i>	Atmosphere
Camera notes	Environment + Location (react to it, based on budget natural)
Lighting notes (units, gels, mood, et al)	Visual Reference
Special Gear + Special Crew	
Requests - from Production, Locations, Production Designer, et al	
Lighting Practicals request to Production Designer	Create the Rules, Create the Style
Overheads + Floorplans (given to art, gaffer et al) (only if necessary)	
Storyboards (if needed for the scene or for complex ones)	
Characters	You must plan the fully edited 30-second sequence on paper, with accurate shot-by-shot timings – Absolutely vital!
Reference Images / Clips / Photos / Artwork	
Actor Faces / Character Rules	Casting / Actors
Technical Pages - slog2 details, ire, stops above and below,	Location As Character
	Camera + Character
Management	
	Lighting
Location - Scout Sheet	
	Art
Gear List	
	Effects
Crew List	
Budget	

Director of Photography / Cinematographer Responsibilities

The Director of Photography, also known as the "DP", the "Cameraman" and the "Cinematographer", is the head or first cameraman of the production and is directly responsible to the Director. The DP helps the Director translate the written word to the screen in close cooperation, supervising and operating the lighting and camera crews in the most efficient manner possible and within the budget set by the Unit Production Manager. Duties and responsibilities include the following:

- Selecting the type and quantity of camera equipment for the production.
- Selecting the tape stock to be used and making sure it is properly pre-blackened.
- Selects, in cooperation with the Director, the tape stock and its handling for the overall "look" of the picture.
- Determining exposures and making sure that the camera has been white and black balanced properly.
- Determines the quantity and type of lights to be used in the production.
- Supervises the intensity, color balance and placement of all lighting.
- Supervises the gelling of windows, areas and lights for proper color balance and/or effect.
- Works closely with the Director in setting up the shots to create continuity of action, screen direction, energy level lighting and effects, etc.
- Works closely with the Director in selecting angles, camera height, and movement, whether on a tripod, dolly, PanaGlide, crane, SkyCam, vehicle (land, air or water) or hand held.
- Grants the Director final authority on all camera movement and placement without resistance.
- Determines the f stop the tape will be exposed at.
- Establishes and maintains the desired photographic quality for the entire picture such that it is consistent from scene to scene no matter what order the picture is shot in.
- Requests additions, alterations and deletions of make-up on actors in keeping with the overall continuity and look of the picture.
- Makes sure all sets, backgrounds, wardrobe and props have the proper "photographic" quality and that they do not contain paint or pigments that, unseen by the human eye, will render cyan, magenta, yellow or some other color shift on tape.
- In cooperation with the Director's selection of angles and the effect desired, advises on dept of field of various lenses and selects the proper lens to be used for each take.

- Sets the composition of each shot for the Camera Operator before each take.
- Works quickly with the Director in planning each setup and relays such, to his crew.
- Expedites and supervises the entire camera crew on each camera and on each unit.
- Does not operate in a ridged fashion but is cooperative with the director when he or she senses or orders changes in setups, lighting, camera moves, etc.
- Is flexible, fluid and fast in his approach to camera work, and knows lighting intuitively.
- Is creative and innovative in his or her approach to cinematography, but does not drive the production over budget with wild ideas that burn tape with no results.
- Is familiar with all material in Cameraman's Check sheet as such may apply to tape and applies both as applicable.
- Provides and uses an excellent light meter, contrast viewer and other equipment normally used by DPs.
- Requests additions, alterations and deletions of make-up on actors in keeping with the overall continuity and look of the picture.
- Makes sure all sets, backgrounds, wardrobe and props have the proper "photographic" quality and that they do not contain paint or pigments that, unseen by the human eye, will render cyan, magenta, yellow or some other color shift on tape.
- In cooperation with the Director's selection of angles and the effect desired, advises on dept of field of various lenses and selects the proper lens to be used for each take.
- Sets the composition of each shot for the Camera Operator before each take.
- Works quickly with the Director in planning each setup and relays such, to his crew.
- Expedites and supervises the entire camera crew on each camera and on each unit.
- Does not operate in a ridged fashion but is cooperative with the director when he or she senses or orders changes in setups, lighting, camera moves, etc.
- Is flexible, fluid and fast in his approach to camera work, and knows lighting intuitively.
- Is creative and innovative in his or her approach to cinematography, but does not drive the production over budget with wild ideas that burn tape with no results.
- Is familiar with all material in Cameraman's Check sheet as such may apply to tape and applies both as applicable.
- Provides and uses an excellent light meter, contrast viewer and other equipment normally used by DPs.

Definition of Cinematography

"Cinematography is a creative and interpretive process that culminates in the authorship of an original work of art rather than the simple recording of a physical event.

Cinematography is not a subcategory of photography. Rather, photography is but one craft that the cinematographer uses in addition to other physical, organizational, managerial, interpretive and image-manipulating techniques to effect one coherent process.

These visual images from the cinema, extending from conception and preproduction through postproduction to the ultimate presentation and all processes that may affect these images, are the direct responsibility and interest of the cinematographer.

The image that the cinematographer brings to the screen come from the artistic vision, imagination and skill of the cinematographer as he or she works within a collaborative relationship with fellow artists."

- John Hora, ASC

Responsibilities of the Cinematographer

I. PreProduction

Conceptual Research and Design

- Discuss all aspects of script and director's approach to picture in preliminary talks with director
- Analyze script as whole
- Analyze story structure
- Analyze characters
- Research period, events, general subject and appropriate design elements
- Devise style, visualize approach
- Continue talks with director on new ideas
- Come to agreement with director
- Discuss and come to agreement with production designer
- Discuss and research with technical advisor

Practical Research and Design

- Ascertain or find out budget requirements
- Scout and approve locations
- Plot sun position for location
- Check local weather
- Check tide tables near ocean
- Review, discuss and approve set plans
- Review, discuss and approve spotting plans for stages
- Review and approve props, picture cars, airplanes, boats, horse-drawn vehicles, mock-ups and miniatures

Technical Research and Design

- Visit laboratory to calibrate, customize and evaluate exposure system for any combination of electronic or chemical image capture; establish developing, printing, set timing and transfer protocols
- Visit equipment vendors
- Explore new equipment
- Learn how new equipment works
- Invent (or cause to be invented) special equipment or technique for show
- Standardize and create effects bible for show
- Help create and approve any storyboards
- Design (or cause to be designed) and approve any built-in or practical lighting fixture
- Design lighting-plot plan and rigging for stages and locations with gaffer and key grip

Quality Control

- Choose and approve crew, film stock, lab, equipment, second-unit and visual-effects crews
- Supervise manufacture and testing of new or modified equipment
- Visit sets under construction
- Approve wild walls, ceiling pieces and any moving set pieces
- Check lighting-fixtures crew
- Walk locations and stages with all departments to discuss requirements
- Approve set colors and textures
- Approve costume colors and textures
- Approve make-up and hair
- Generate (or cause to be generated) and approve equipment list for camera, electric and grip
- Check dailies screening rooms for correct standards

Implementation

- Cast stand-ins

- Train crew to use any new equipment
- Walk locations and stages with director and devise shooting plan
- Make list of special equipment for production manager and indicate number of days required
- Work with assistant director on shooting schedule (order of and days required for each scene)
- Estimate and order film stock (type, size, quantity)
- Generate (or cause to be generated) and approve rigging and shooting manpower and man-days
- Assist other departments in getting required equipment, manpower and tests
- Drop by all departments and visit department heads at least twice a day to answer any questions
- Mediate any problems between departments
- Check loading of production trucks or cargo containers for location or international shipping
- Visit cast run-through and rehearsals
- Advise and back up director on any problems
- Help producer or studio solve any production problems

Testing

- Shoot tests for style
- Shoot tests for lab
- Shoot tests for lighting of principal actors
- Shoot tests for camera and lenses
- Shoot tests for wardrobe and makeup
- Shoot tests for any special effects processes, unusual rigs, props or methods

II. Shooting (Production)

Planning

- Check and approve all call sheets and shooting order of the day's work

Blocking

- Watch rehearsal of scene to be shot
- Devise shot list with director (coverage)
- Choose lens and composition, show to director for approval
- Make sure composition and movement fulfill scene task
- Work out mechanical problems with camera operator, assistant camera, dolly and crane grips
- Set any camera-movement cues
- Place stand-ins and rehearse, fine-tune
- Ensure proper coverage of scene for editor
- Work with assistant director on background action

Lighting

- Design lighting to show set/location to best advantage relative to story, style and dramatic content
- Light each actor to reinforce and reveal character
- Make sure mood and tone of light help tell story
- Design light for minimum reset between set-ups
- Utilize stand-by painter for control of highlights, shadows, aging, dusting down of sets and props
- Set and match light value, volume, color and contrast of each setup (exposure)
- Set any lighting cues (dimmers, spot lights, color changes and any pre-programming)

Preparation

- Work out any sound problems
- Work out any problems with other departments
- Check, set and approve all stunts with stunt coordinator
- Set any additional cameras required for stunts
- Double-check safety with all concerned

- Show shot to director to make any final changes
- Get actors in for final mechanical rehearsal; solve any outstanding problems

Photography

- Photograph scene
- Approve or correct take
- Check parameters and reset for next take
- Shoot any plates
- Shoot any video playback material
- Move to next setup

Administrative

- Define first setup in morning and after lunch
- Make sure stills are taken of scene
- See that "making off" and/or EPK crews get needed footage
- Make sure script supervisor has any special camera or lighting notes
- Check film raw stock inventory
- Try to shoot up short ends
- Check that camera log book is being kept up to date
- Complete day's work
- Discuss first setup for the next day
- Ensure camera, electrical and grip crews get all copies of equipment rental or purchase invoices and approve before accountants pay vendors
- Take care of any future or ongoing production issues
- Answer any questions about future problems
- Visit production manager and producer at end of day
- Check for return of all unused equipment

Quality Control

- Call in for lab report
- View previous day's work in projected dailies with director, producer, editor, camera crew
- Discuss and approve dailies
- Consult with makeup, wardrobe, production designer and assistant director about dailies
- View, discuss, correct or approve second-unit or effects dailies
- Order reprints if necessary

Training

- Teach beginning actors movie technique (hitting marks, size of frame, lenses, etc.)
- Train camera crew for next job up the ladder

Contingency

- If director is disabled, finish day's shooting for him or her

III. PostProduction

Additional Photography

- Discuss and be aware of delivery dates for all postproduction
- Photograph and approve any additional scenes, inserts, special effects or second-unit footage
- Timing (Color and Density)
- Time and approve trailer for theaters and TV
- Approve all optical and digital effects composites
- Time the picture

- Retime until correct

Quality Control

- Approve final answer print
- Show to director for OK
- Approve interpositive (IP)
- Approve internegatives (IN)
- Approve release prints
- Approve show prints from original negative
- Approve all blowups or reductions

Telecine / Color Correction

- Supervise and approve film or digital transfer to electronic or film media (Hi-Def, NTSC, PAL, Secam masters, digital intermediates, archival masters, etc.)
- Supervise and approve all transfers to and from digital intermediates (DI)
- Supervise and approve all letterbox, pan and scan, or reformatting of film
- Supervise and approve tape-to-tape color correction and VHS, DVD, digital projection media, etc.
- Show electronic transfers to director for OK

Publicity

- Do any publicity (newspaper, magazine, Internet, radio, TV, DVD commentary, etc.)

Restoration / Archival

- Be available for any future reissue, archival reprint or electronic transfer of film

Intrapixel - contrast, density, color idiosyncrasies, highlight roll off, skitone handling,

Temporal - motion blur, exposure, frame rate,

Spatial - resolution, apparent sharpness, halation, weave,

Halation, Film Gate Weave

Color Transformation

Tone Mapping

<http://yedlin.net/OnColorScience/>

Lens qualities:

mechanics - aperture/speed, close focus, mechanics, size, weight

character - color cast warm cool, bokeh, spherical aberration, chromatic aberration, overall sharpness, focus fall off, creamy, distortion, vignetting, catseye effect, flare, veiling flare, ghosting, contrast, breathing

Image Pipeline - creative intent, lens, filtration, camera system, lighting composition etc, color grading, end user

COLOR THEORY meaning

Pink - sweetness, femininity, sweetness, charm, beauty, delicate, playful, passivity

Purple - royalty, fantasy, ethereal, erotic, mystical, power, wealth, introspection

Blue - cold, depression, loyalty, peace, passivity, calm, trustworthy, sadness, wisdom

Green - environment, immaturity, corruption, ominous, dark, envy, balance, rebirth

Orange - warm, enthusiasm, friendly, vibrant, happiness, determination, stimulating

Yellow - madness, illness, insecurity, obsessive, wisdom, betrayal, hope, optimism

Red - love, desire, violence, danger, aggression, intensity, sexy,

Camera Operator Panel

Communication

Email and intro to everyone - safety and excited to be on.

Dolly Grip, Camera Assistants, Boom Op, DP, AD, etc.

On set dresser

Discuss what aiming to do visually with DP and what has already been set. Technically and aesthetically.

Check in with A-cam 1sts for extra info. Especially when dayplaying. Maybe sometimes actors (introduce, ask how they like to be referred to, and if they want to know frame sizes)

Build rapport with people.

Go peak at the monitor to absorb the vibe.

Ask A cam about framing and headroom and movement.

Be proactive.

Be welcoming.

Team Communication -